

D.J. PARIS

RATES FELL AGAIN. BUYERS STILL AREN'T SIGNING.

Pending sales just hit their lowest point since January. The rate was never the real objection.

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YOUR BUYER ISN'T WAITING ON A NUMBER ANYMORE.

Contract signings dropped to an eight-month low even as rates eased. Something else is holding them back.

THE OBJECTION CHANGED. MOST SCRIPTS DIDN'T.

Freddie Mac's own weekly survey shows the 30-year fixed easing to **6.65%** the week of August 20, down from 6.67% the week before. NAR's Pending Home Sales Report, out August 18, shows signed contracts fell 2.3% in July and sit at their lowest level since January. If the rate alone were the blocker, a small drop should have moved that number. It didn't. The hesitation sitting in most pipelines right now is confidence, not math, and a rate update doesn't answer it.

WHAT TO ASK INSTEAD OF QUOTING THE RATE:

- 1 "What would make you feel confident closing this month, not just the rate?"**
Surfaces the real hesitation instead of a number neither of you controls.
- 2 "If prices dip after you buy, what's your plan?"**
Answers the fear directly instead of arguing rates will fall further.
- 3 "What does this house cost at today's price trend in six months?"**
Replaces a rate debate with a dollar one they can picture.

THE TAKEAWAY

THE RATE CONVERSATION WAS NEVER THE OBJECTION.

The confidence conversation is. Have that one next.

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